



Published by:

ECONOMIC PLANNING UNIT SARAWAK,
DEPARTMENT OF THE PREMIER OF SARAWAK
6th & 7th Floor
Wisma Bapa Malaysia
Petra Jaya
93502 Kuching
Sarawak
Tel: (+6) 082 - 319 380 / 440 857
Fax: (+6) 082 - 449 481 / 442 536

All Rights Reserved. ©

No part of this publication may be reproduced, copied, stored in any retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means - electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording or otherwise; without prior permission from the Economic Planning Unit Sarawak, Department of the Premier of Sarawak.

Whilst every reasonable care has been taken in preparing this document, the Sarawak Government cannot be held responsible for any inaccuracies. All information and specifications are current at the time of preparation and are subject to change as may be required.



Sarawak Government

PCDS POST COVID-19 **2030** DEVELOPMENT STRATEGY 2030

HIGHLIGHTS 2023



Foreword

Premier of Sarawak

The Right Honourable Datuk Patinggi Tan Sri (Dr)

Abang Haji Abdul Rahman Zohari bin Tun Datuk Abang Haji Openg



Assalamualaikum Warahmatullahi Wabarakatuh and Salam Sarawak Maju Makmur.

It is my privilege to present the **Post COVID-19 Development Strategy 2030 (PCDS 2030): Highlights 2023** showcasing the achievements and progress in Sarawak's journey towards our PCDS 2030 aspirations.

The resilience and adaptability of Sarawak's economy is evident in how we have recovered from the global turbulence caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Under my administration, the Sarawak Government acted swiftly to cushion the negative economic impact of COVID-19 through the provision of the *Bantuan Khas Sarawakku Sayang* (BKSS) aid amounting to RM6.7 billion, between March 2020 and January 2022. This aid provided a crucial lifeline to individuals, B40 families as well as Micro, Small and Medium-sized Enterprises, in the form of cash assistance, discount of utility bills, fee waivers, deferment of payment for land premiums and deferment of payment for loan schemes under the Sarawak Government.

In July 2021, the Sarawak Government launched the **Post COVID-19 Development Strategy 2030 (PCDS 2030)** to propel Sarawak towards a comprehensive transformation, ensuring Sarawak emerges as a stronger and more resilient region. As a result of our efforts, Sarawak's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) grew at an average Annual Growth Rate of 3.8% between 2021 and 2023.

Over the past three (3) years, we have seen remarkable advancements in all key sectors. Our targeted focus on economic diversification, digitalisation and transition towards a low carbon economy is starting to bear fruit.

We envision that by 2030, Sarawak will be a thriving society driven by data and innovation where everyone enjoys economic prosperity, social inclusivity and a sustainable environment.

The World Bank in 2022 acknowledged Sarawak as a high-income economy, by the measure of Gross National Income (GNI) per capita of US\$ 18,360. This recognition proves that we are on the right track towards becoming a high income and developed economy under PCDS 2030. We will continue to champion our aspirations of Economic Prosperity, Social Inclusivity and Environmental Sustainability.



In 2023, the Sarawak Government achieved a record revenue of RM13.3 billion (from a revenue of RM7.3 billion in 2019), signalling our strong financial position and ability to fund crucial development and social welfare initiatives. We also recorded a total approved investment value of RM22.8 billion across all sectors, as we continue to strengthen Sarawak's critical advantage of providing renewable energy and facilitating ease of doing business.

We are committed to ensure that our economic prosperity is shared throughout Sarawak. Integral to equitable wealth distribution and social inclusivity is our emphasis on economic diversification, the creation of high-income jobs and targeted social interventions. Employment in Sarawak increased from 1.31 million in 2022 to 1.41 million in 2023, while the unemployment rate decreased from 3.7% to 3.5%. The Sarawak Government continues to care for the people through various initiatives, including welfare assistance for vulnerable groups, entrepreneurship programmes, repair of dilapidated schools and clinics, provision of affordable housing and supporting programmes for persons with disabilities.

Environmental sustainability remains a key focus for Sarawak, with continued efforts to incorporate new technologies, innovate sustainable practices, and reinforce regulatory frameworks. In support of the Malaysian Greening Programme, Sarawak planted 32.5 million trees between 2021 to 2023. In November 2023, Sarawak achieved a milestone with the passage of the Environment (Reduction of Greenhouse Gases Emission) Bill, signalling a significant move towards addressing carbon emissions. This legislation strengthens our commitment to ensuring that Sarawak achieves net-zero carbon emissions by 2050.

The progress and achievements recorded in **PCDS 2030: Highlights 2023** are testaments to the hard work and resolute commitment of the Sarawak Government, private sector companies and our local communities. In earnest confidence, I express my firm belief that the synergy between our efficient Civil Service, dynamic private sector, and the steadfast support of our people will elevate Sarawak to unprecedented heights. Together, we stand ready to embrace the challenges that lie ahead, accelerating Sarawak to new horizons of achievement and distinction.



Foreword

Sarawak State Secretary
YB Datuk Amar Haji Mohamad Abu Bakar bin Marzuki



Assalamualaikum Warahmatullahi Wabarakatuh.

As we embark on the journey of reflection in **Post COVID-19 Development Strategy 2030 (PCDS 2030): Highlights 2023**, I am compelled to express my gratitude for the collective efforts that have shaped Sarawak's progress. The achievements over the past year stand as a testament to our unwavering commitment to the holistic development of Sarawak in line with PCDS 2030.

The publication of this inaugural annual report marks a significant milestone in our journey towards transforming Sarawak into a developed economy by 2030. This document serves as a comprehensive overview of the Sarawak Government's aspirations, providing detailed insights into our strategic initiatives, key achievements, and progress made in 2023. Published in two languages (English and Bahasa Malaysia) and accessible online, **PCDS 2030: Highlights 2023** underscores our commitment to transparency and accountability, offering a clear view of our current performance and future direction.

The achievements showcased in this report are not just statistical figures, indeed, they represent tangible improvements in the lives of Sarawakians, across all geographic locations, income groups and cultural backgrounds. Key highlights include the increase of internet coverage in Sarawak to 78.8%, a recovery in our Tourism sector with 3.9 million visitor arrivals, expansion of our road network to a total of 13,577 km and 99.4% electricity supply coverage for households in Sarawak with the successful implementation of the Sarawak Alternative Rural Electrification Scheme (SARES).

With **PCDS 2030: Highlights 2023**, we aim to keep Sarawakians engaged in our efforts and advancements, while strengthening the confidence of our domestic and international partners to develop innovative and long-lasting collaborations in Sarawak. I wish to extend a warm invitation to partners and investors to explore the vast opportunities arising from our strategic initiatives across all sectors.

I commend the dedication of our leaders, ministries, departments, agencies, federal counterparts, and external stakeholders who have been instrumental in turning our PCDS 2030 aspirations into reality. As we move forward, let us continue working hand in hand to script a future where Sarawak stands tall as a model of Economic Prosperity, Social Inclusivity and Environmental Sustainability.

Foreword

Advisors in the Office of the Premier of Sarawak

YBhg. Datuk Amar Jaul Samion &

YBhg. Datu Ir. Haji Zuraimi bin Haji Sabki



When the Sarawak Government launched PCDS 2030 in July 2021, we were faced with numerous challenges caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. The spread of the virus and extended national lockdowns affected trade, business and hindered our everyday lives. The year 2023 has been a critical turning point for our efforts, exemplified by our achievements across various sectors reported in this inaugural annual report, **PCDS 2030: Highlights 2023**.

As advisors for PCDS 2030, we have worked together closely with the Performance Management and Delivery (PMD) team in the Economic Planning Unit Sarawak in monitoring the implementation of PCDS 2030. Our team has facilitated more than 150 engagement sessions with Ministries, Departments, Agencies as well as representatives from the private sector as of December 2023 in our efforts to prioritise key projects, set yearly targets and quarterly milestones, as well as problem solve critical issues which affect the implementation of PCDS 2030. Progress towards PCDS 2030 aspirations in every key sector is diligently monitored and evaluated by the leadership of the Sarawak Government, through the PCDS 2030 Quarterly Dashboards.

The publication of **PCDS 2030: Highlights 2023** enables the Sarawak Government to share our progress to the public and key stakeholders, ensuring accountability and transparency in our efforts and commitment towards the people of Sarawak. We welcome feedback from all parties in order to ensure that we continuously improve the services and projects implemented by the Sarawak Government.

We would like to express our deepest gratitude to the Sarawak Economic Action Council headed by The Right Honourable Datuk Patinggi Tan Sri (Dr) Abang Haji Abdul Rahman Zohari bin Tun Datuk Abang Haji Openg, Premier of Sarawak, The Honourable State Secretary, Ministries and Departments, Government Linked Companies, private sector players and community members who have contributed to the PCDS 2030 achievements. Their unwavering commitment and tireless efforts have been instrumental in the progress made over the past year.

As we look forward to the future, we are excited about the opportunities and challenges that lie ahead. With our collective efforts, Sarawak will continue to make significant strides towards our shared PCDS 2030 vision.



Contents

Forewords 2 - 5

Premier of Sarawak	2
Sarawak State Secretary	4
Advisors in the Office of the Premier of Sarawak	5

Socio Economic Highlights 2023 8

Key Achievements 9

Chapter 1: Introduction 10 - 19

Introduction	12
Summary of PCDS 2030	14
Sarawak's 2030 Aspirations	16
PCDS Monitoring & Implementation	18

Chapter 2: Economic Sectors 20 - 71

Manufacturing	22
Commercial Agriculture	28
Tourism	38
Forestry	48
Mining	56
Social Services	64

Chapter 3: Enablers 72 - 127

Digital Transformation	74
Innovation	82
Education & Human Capital	90
Basic Infrastructure	98
Utilities	108
Transport	116
Renewable Energy	122

Chapter 4: Conclusion & Moving Forward 128 - 129

Acronyms 130 - 134

Credits 135

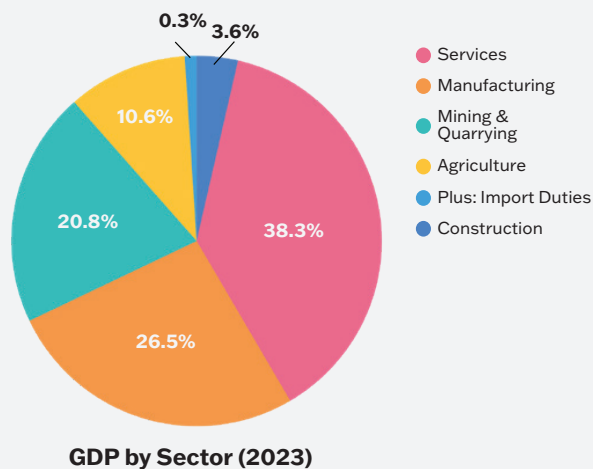
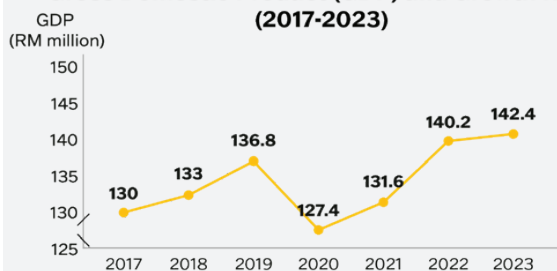
Socio-Economic Highlights 2023



**RM142.2
billion**

**Sarawak's GDP 2023
(at constant 2015 price)**

**Gross Domestic Product (GDP) and Growth Rate
(2017-2023)**



Trade (2023)



**RM130
billion
Export**



**RM63
billion
Import**



**RM193
billion
Total Trade**

Top 5 Trading Partners (2021-2023)

1



**Peninsular
Malaysia**

2



Japan

3



China

4



South Korea

5



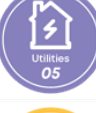
India



RM13.3 billion

Sarawak's Government Revenue in 2023

Key PCDS 2030 Achievements in 2023

6 ECONOMIC SECTORS	 Manufacturing 01	Sarawak attracted investments amounting to RM21.5 billion since 2021, fostering the creation of over 11,000 employment opportunities.
	 Agriculture 02	The Agriculture sector contributed 10.6% of Sarawak's GDP in 2023, amounting to RM14.5 billion .
	 Tourism 03	Sarawak recorded 3.9 million visitor arrivals in 2023, stimulating RM9.99 billion in tourism receipts.
	 Forestry 04	Sarawak planted 32.5 million trees from the year 2021 to 2023 and revamped its Forestry sector for sustainability.
	 Mining 05	Sarawak's Mining sector includes the quarrying segments, contributing RM1.48 billion to the GDP, accounting for 20.8% in 2023.
	 Services 06	Sarawak Social Wellbeing Index 2023 interim final report recorded a score of 7.18/10 .
7 ENABLERS	 Digital Transformation 01	Internet coverage reached 78.8% encompassing 279 towers under <i>Pelan Jalinan Digital Negara</i> (JENDELA) and 183 towers under Sarawak Multimedia Authority Rural Telecommunication (SMART).
	 Innovation 02	The strong innovation ecosystem enabled the Sarawak Government to support 78 innovations and digitalised 6,233 Small and Medium-sized Enterprises.
	 Education & Human Capital 03	58 school repair projects completed, as of 2023, benefitting 15,081 students.
	 Basic Infrastructure 04	As of 2023, Sarawak has built an extensive network of roads spanning 31,577 km .
	 Utilities 05	Electricity supply coverage has reached 99.4% , and water supply coverage is at 84.3% .
	 Transport 06	As of 2023, the ridership for public bus transport in Sarawak under the RM1 Flat Rate Bus Fare subsidy programme has increased to 4.38 million , an increase of 256% since May 2020.
	 Renewable Energy 07	In 2023, Sarawak maintained 60% Renewable Energy Capacity Mix and sold 5 million Renewable Energy Certificates (REC).

CHAPTER 1:

Introduction





INTRODUCTION

The economic landscape of Sarawak was impacted by the COVID-19 pandemic. In 2020, the region saw a widespread decline in economic activities, with a shrink in exports by 24.2% and a rise in the unemployment rate to 4.3%. Despite these challenges, the pandemic catalysed digitalisation across various sectors and underscored the significance of maintaining a robust global supply chain. As of November 2023, 328,256 COVID-19 cases were reported in Sarawak since the first case in March 2020.

The Sarawak Government introduced nine packages under the *Bantuan Khas Sarawakku Sayang* (BKSS) initiative. These packages, totaling RM6.7 billion, were implemented to alleviate the financial burden experienced by the public amidst the COVID-19 pandemic.

The Sarawak Government introduced **9 BKSS** packages amounting to **RM6.7 billion** from **23 March 2020** to **29 August 2022** to ease the financial burden of the people during the **COVID-19** pandemic

Bantuan Khas Sarawakku Sayang (BKSS)



RM6.7 billion



Cash Assistance

B40 Families, Frontliners, Media Personnel, Special Grant for Hawkers, Penambang, Van Operators, Taxi Drivers, School Bus, Tourist & Park Guides, E-hailing Drivers & Driving Instructors



Discount

Water, Electricity Bills, Rental of Market and Stalls, Assessment Rate, Land Rent & Housing Development Corporation (HDC) Rent



Waiver

Hotel License Fees & Permits, Rentals to Small and Medium-sized Enterprises (SMEs)



Deferment

Loan Scheme for Medium and Small Industry (SPIKS), Repayment & Land Premium



Other Assistance

Micro-credit schemes, Interest Free Soft Loan for SMEs, Face Mask, Personal protective equipment (PPE), Food, Mobile bank



Variation of Price (VOP)

Sarawak BKSS (2020-2022). (Source: EPU Sarawak)

PCDS 2030 was launched by The Right Honourable Datuk Patinggi Tan Sri (Dr) Abang Haji Abdul Rahman Zohari Bin Tun Datuk Abang Haji Openg, Premier of Sarawak in July 2021. This strategy was developed to transform Sarawak into a developed state by 2030 by achieving economic prosperity, social inclusivity, and environmental sustainability. The Sarawak Economic Action Council (SEAC) played a significant role in formulating the PCDS 2030, studying the details of the state's economic, social, and governance sectors. Furthermore, the development of this strategy involved more than 20,000 man-hours engagement sessions with various stakeholders from the public, private sectors and communities to ensure the inclusivity of the plan.



PCDS 2030 Aspirations



Elevate Sarawak economy from RM136 billion in 2019 to RM282 billion in 2030



Grow Sarawak economy 8% per annum between 2021 and 2030



Create 195,000 new job opportunities



Raise median household income to RM15,000



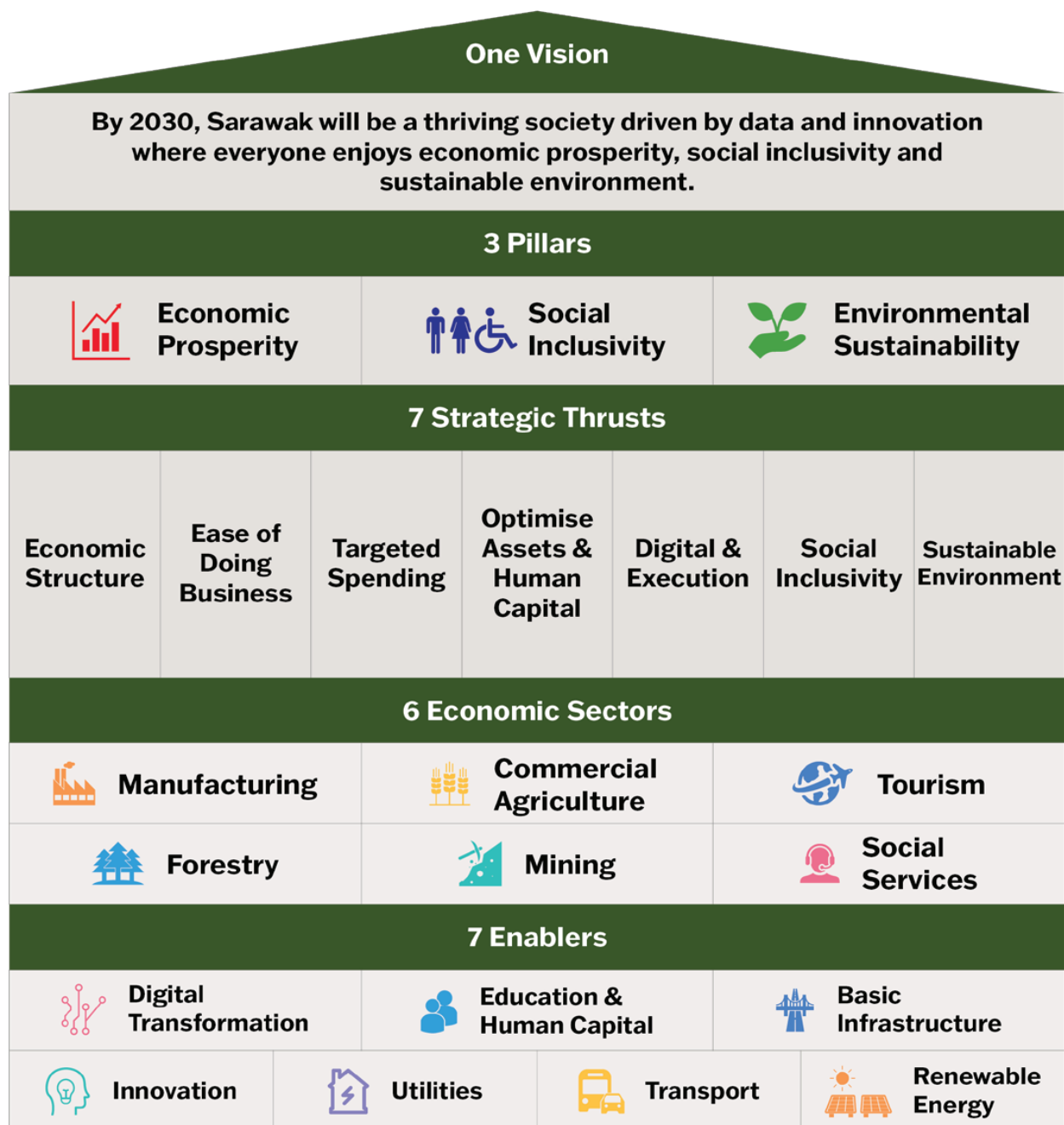
Reduce urban and rural development gaps



Improve work efficiency, enhance productivity via Digital Innovations

PCDS 2030 Aspirations. (Source: Post COVID-19 Development Strategy 2030)

SUMMARY OF PCDS 2030







PCDS MONITORING & IMPLEMENTATION

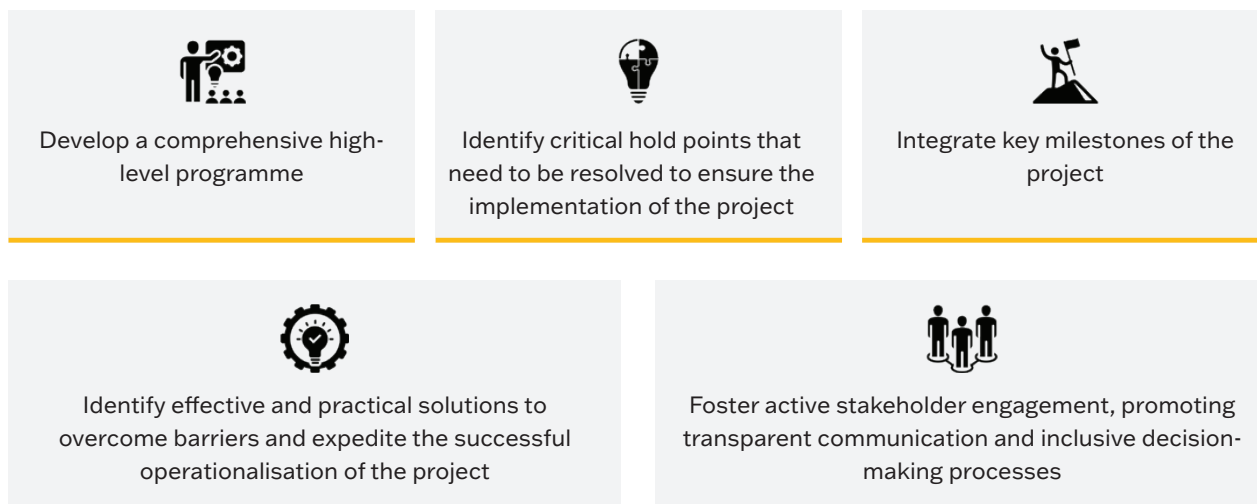
PCDS 2030 implementation is monitored by the Performance Management and Delivery (PMD) Division in the Economic Planning Unit Sarawak. Two (2) advisors have also been appointed by the Sarawak Government to advise The Right Honourable Datuk Patinggi Tan Sri (Dr) Abang Haji Abdul Rahman Zohari Bin Tun Datuk Abang Haji Openg, Premier of Sarawak on matters related to PCDS 2030, namely YBhg. Datuk Amar Jaul Samion and YBhg. Datu Ir. Hj. Zuraimi bin Hj. Sabki.

The PCDS 2030 Advisors with the PMD team execute five (5) key roles in monitoring the implementation of PCDS 2030 priority initiatives:



The PCDS 2030 advisors and PMD team work closely with Sarawak Government ministries and agencies for each of the six (6) Economic Sectors and seven (7) Enablers under PCDS 2030 to ensure that projects and programmes are implemented as planned. Each sector has long-term goals for 2030 as well as project/programme milestones which are tracked through a Quarterly Performance Dashboard for each sector. The dashboards are reviewed by the Sarawak Government leadership to monitor progress and to problem solve any obstacles or delays faced by the implementing agency.

The team has also developed a methodology for Strategic Intervention Workshops to integrate the planning and delivery of complex projects which involve multiple agencies. These workshops aim to:



The PMD team is also tasked with communicating PCDS 2030 aspirations and PCDS 2030 implementation, including the production of the PCDS 2030: Highlights 2023 document. As of the end of 2023, there were over 150 engagement sessions, exhibitions, talks, and courtesy calls for the general public conducted by PCDS 2030 Advisors and the PMD team.

In 2024, the PMD team will roll-out a comprehensive training programme for key Sarawak Government officers leading PCDS 2030 priority projects and programmes. This training programme will supplement the Enhanced High Performing Leaders Programme in the Sarawak Civil Service and will cover four (4) modules crucial for successful project delivery, namely Policy Analysis, Project Management, Stakeholder Management and Programme Evaluation.